

DISTRICT 5 VOLLEYBALL TOURNAMENT FORMAT AND DATES

TO: District 5 Volleyball Schools

FR: Scott Shirley
District 5 Volleyball Director

RE: Rules and Dates

Welcome to the 2026 season!

In order to prepare for the season, I have enclosed the volleyball format.

Please fill out a rating sheet with your current information, along with the date, opponent, and class, and return it to me. Forms can be found on the District 5 Website under the “District Forms” link. Original schedules should be turned in to Scott Close (volleyball statistician) and I (volleyball chair) by August 27, 2026. Scott Close at sclose@sasd.us and Scott Shirley at sshirl@sasd.us

Rating Sheets are to be submitted by 12:00 (noon) every **Monday** beginning September 21, 2026. E-mail attachments are the preferred method of submission. **Send reports to, Scott Close, District 5 Volleyball Statistician at sclose@sasd.us**

Please be sure to review the “Important Dates” section as there have been changes to the District cut-off date and the first round on the District 5 Playoffs.

Teams not interested in participating in the District 5 Tournament must let the Volleyball Chairman (Scott Shirley) know no later than October 19, 2026 @ sshirl@sasd.us

If any discrepancies arise in the weekly report, please notify me immediately.

Have a great season!

DISTRICT 5 VOLLEYBALL FORMAT - 2026

2026-27 P.I.A.A. DISTRICT 5 RANKING SYSTEM

A. POINT SYSTEM – SPORTS WITH 6 CLASSIFICATIONS (Volleyball)

1. A team receives 6 points for a win
2. Bonus points are awarded on the following basis:
 - 1 point awarded for a win over a class 1A school, total 7 points**
 - 2 points awarded for a win over a class 2A school, total of 8 points**
 - 3 points awarded for a win over a class 3A school, total of 9 points**
 - 4 points awarded for a win over a class 4A school, total of 10 points**
 - 5 points awarded for a win over a class 5A school, total of 11 points**
 - 6 points awarded for a win over a class 6A school, total of 12 points**

B. RANKING AND PLAYOFF INFORMATION – INDIVIDUAL SPORTS -GIRLS VOLLEYBALL

1. A minimum of 11 games played are necessary to qualify for playoffs.
2. Ranking is determined by total points accumulated divided by the total games played, excluding tournaments, scrimmages, and exhibitions.
3. Minimum of six schools advance into Class 1A and Class 2A districts. Class 3A will compete in Sub-Regional playoff with Districts 5, 8 & 9. The Sub-Regional will be hosted by District 9. Class 4A will compete in a Sub-Regional playoff with Districts 5, 6 & 8. The Sub-Regional will be hosted by District 6.
4. Additional qualifiers in each classification must have won at least 50% of their games, excluding scrimmages and tournament games.
5. PIAA has six classes for ranking purposes, Class 1A, Class 2A, Class3A, Class 4A, Class 5A, and Class 6A.

C. ADDITIONAL POINT SYSTEM INFORMATION – ALL SPORTS

1. No points are awarded for a loss regardless of opponent's classification.
Victories over out of state opponents will receive the same bonus points from that sport's PIAA classification system. The Principal and/or Athletic Director will secure in writing from the out of state opponents the current enrollment of males and females eligible to participate from grades 10-12 in the year in which the contest will be held. District 5 schools shall list the enrollment beside the opponent's name on the District 5 Rating Sheet. Victories over non-PIAA opponents will receive the lowest point total awarded in that classification for a victory.
2. Tournament games, scrimmages, and exhibition games (example: alumni games) do not count in ranking.
3. Forfeiture of a contest will be governed by PIAA rules.
4. Rankings are based on all school schedules that are turned into the District V Statistician by the first legal starting date for that sports season. If games are lost by a school because a scheduled opponent disbands their team before the first legal play date, they may schedule other games for

ranking. If games are lost by a school because a scheduled opponent disbands their team after the first legal play date, they may receive forfeits for the games lost.

5. In order to be considered for ranking purposes, in District 5 Playoffs, a minimum number of contests must be played against PIAA member schools or non-PIAA schools that are in good standing with their respective National Federation of State High School Association and member state high school association. It is the responsibility of District 5 member schools to insure that all contests submitted meet PIAA and District 5 rules:
6. Schools must complete a minimum of 60% of the PIAA maximum number of contests allowed as set forth in the PIAA Constitution & By-Laws.
7. Tournament matches, scrimmages, and exhibition matches (ex. Alumni Games) do not count in ranking. A PIAA member school is permitted to participate in a maximum of **22** volleyball competitions based on the following method of counting volleyball competitions: **1 team competition** for each dual match: **2 team competitions** for each quadrangular match, for each triangular match, and for each tournament involving 3 or more teams. A minimum number of **14 matches** must be scheduled.
8. Tie breaking procedures would be as currently established. (See District 5 Handbook)

RANKING AND PLAYOFF INFORMATION

1. Ranking is determined by total points accumulated divided by the total games played, excluding tournaments, scrimmages, and exhibitions.
2. All schools with a .500 record have the right to advance into the Class A and 2A District Tournament, possibly through a play-in system. Otherwise, the top 6 teams in Class A and 2A will enter the District 5 Volleyball Tournament. The top four teams in Class 3A will qualify and participate in the District 9 3A volleyball tournament. The top four teams in Class 4A will qualify and participate in the District 6 4A volleyball tournament.
3. Team and Classifications below:
9 1A – Teams
Top 6 Teams Qualify or .500 record or better in District 5 Tournament
1 - State Qualifier (@ District 9-1 seed)
Berlin Brothersvalley
Fannett-Metal
Forbes Road
Meyersdale
Northern Bedford
Rockwood
Salisbury
Shade – Shanksville
Turkeyfoot Valley

7 2A – Teams = 7 District 5 teams + 0 District 8 teams in 2026

Top 6 Teams Qualify or .500 record or better in District 5 Tournament

1 – State Qualifier (Host District 7-4 seed)

Conemaugh Township

Everett

McConnellsburg

North Star

Southern Fulton

Tussey Mountain

Windber

Westinghouse (District 8)

7 3A – Teams (Subregional = 2 District 5 teams + 2 District 8 teams + 3 District 9 teams)

District 9 will host sub-regional tournament. A maximum of 6 teams will qualify for the AAA subregion based on a qualifying power ranking system.

1 – State Qualifier (Host District 7-3 seed)

Bedford (District 5)

Chestnut Ridge (District 5)

Carrick (District 8)

Perry Traditional Academy (District 8)

Karns City (District 9)

Saint Mary's (District 9)

Brockway (District 9)

5 4A – Teams (Subregional = 1 District 5 team + 2 District 6 teams + 2 District 8 teams)

District 6 will host sub-regional tournament. District 5 (Somerset) will play the winner of the two District 8 teams (Brashear versus Obama Academy) with District 8 hosting this year. The winner advances and plays the winner of Bellefonte and Central Mountain in the sub-regional finals.

1 – State Qualifier (@ District 4-1 seed)

Somerset (District 5)

Bellefonte (District 6)

Central Mountain (District 6)

Brashear (District 8)

Obama Academy (District 8)

TIE BREAKING SYSTEM FOR RANKING ONLY, APPLIED IN ORDER

- A. Head to Head victor, if the teams played each other
- B. Winning percentage versus all common opponents in all games played (regardless of the number of times two schools play each other).
- C. Bonus Points as calculated by wins by defeated opponents divided by games played.
- D. Winning percentage calculated by wins divided by games played. Ties count as half.
- E. Greatest number of wins, excluding tournaments
- F. Coin toss at site convenient to both schools

IMPORTANT DATES FOR 2026

Date	Event
8/17/26 (M)	First Practice
8/22/26 (SA)	First Scrimmage
8/27/26 (R)	Schedules due to VB Chair
8/28/26 (F)	First Play Date
10/19/26 (M)	Playoff Intention Notification Deadline
10/23/26 (F)	Last Day To Count For District 5 Ranking
10/28/26 (W)	AA Quarterfinals (#3 & #4 seeds will host)
10/29/26 (TH)	A – Quarterfinals (#3 & #4 seeds will host)
11/3/26 (T)	AA– Semi-Finals (Highest seed will host) AAA – Quarterfinals (higher seed will host)
11/4/26 (W)	A– Semi-Finals (Highest seed will host)
11/5/22 (R)	AAA – Semi-Finals (District 6 & 8 will host) AAAA – Semi-Finals (District 6 & 8 will host)
11/7/26 (S)	A & AA– Finals (Windber HS or neutral site) AAA – Finals (Neutral Site – Windber HS, if two District 5 teams in the finals) AAAA – Finals (Altoona HS)
11/7/26 (SA)	District Deadline & Last Play Date
11/10/26 (T)	PIAA Playoffs Begin
11/20-21/26 (F & SA)	PIAA Championships (Saint Francis University, Loretto)

DISTRICT 5 VOLLEYBALL TOURNAMENT: CLASS 1A

1. Quarterfinal competition for Class 1A teams will consist of 6 teams. The highest seed will host. These matches will be played using the best 3 out of 5 set match format.

2. **Quarterfinal matches (Class 1A) will be held as follows:**

#1 & #2 ranked schools will receive a bye

At the #3 ranked school: #3 vs #6 @ 7PM

At the #4 ranked school: #4 vs #5 @ 7PM

Teams may take the court for warm-ups at 6:30 PM.

3. **Semi-final matches (Class 1A) will be held as follows:**

Winners of the quarter-final matches from #4 vs #5 will meet the #1 seed @ 7PM. The #1 seed will host.

Winners of the quarter-final matches from #3 vs #6 will meet the #2 seed @ 7PM. The #2 seed will host.

Teams may take the court for warm-ups at 6:30 PM.

4. In the quarterfinal, semi-final and championship matches, the higher seeded team will be considered the “home” team on the scoreboard, will warm-up last on the court, and will be considered the “official scorebook” unless decided upon otherwise by the match referee.
5. The 1A Championship Finals will be played at a neutral site. Windber HS will be the host site.
6. The Principal and/or Athletic Directors of the four final schools may contact the District Tournament Director for comment prior to establishing the actual play-off site. Any objections or comments concerning the final site can be emailed to the volleyball chairperson at sshirl@sasd.us within two hours of the location notification. The volleyball chair will relay comments to the District 5 Chairperson who will make the final decision.
7. All guidelines for determination of the “home” team, order of assigned warm-up, and “official scorebook” will follow regular season practice.
8. All games will follow the PIAA & NFHS guidelines
9. Contact District V Personnel following the game with results:
Jeff Batzel 814-766-4752 & Scott Shirley 814-691-7184 District 5 Tournament Director.

The following announcement must be made at all Volleyball Playoffs: THE OFFICIAL VOLLEYBALL OF DISTRICT 5 IS THE BADEN PERFECTION VX5EC-210 (Red, White, and Blue).

DISTRICT 5 VOLLEYBALL TOURNAMENT: CLASS 2A

1. Quarterfinal competition for Class 2A teams will consist of 6 teams. The highest seed will host. These matches will be played using the best 3 out of 5 set match format.
2. **Quarterfinal matches (Class 2A) will be held as follows:**

#1 & #2 ranked schools will receive a bye

At the #3 ranked school: #3 vs #6 @ 7PM

At the #4 ranked school: #4 vs #5 @ 7PM

Teams may take the court for warm-ups at 6:30 PM.

3. **Semi-final matches (Class 2A) will be held as follows:**

Winners of the quarter-final matches from #4 vs #5 will meet the #1 seed @ 7PM. The #1 seed will host.

Winners of the quarter-final matches from #3 vs #6 will meet the #2 seed @ 7PM. The #2 seed will host.

Teams may take the court for warm-ups at 6:30 PM.

4. In the quarter-final, semi-final and championship matches, the higher seeded team will be considered the “home” team on the scoreboard, will warm-up last on the court, and will be considered the “official scorebook” unless decided upon otherwise by the match referee.
5. The Championship Finals will be played at a neutral site. Windber HS will be the host site unless Windber qualifies for the championship match. The tournament director and District 5 chairman will select a new neutral site if Windber qualifies for the championship match.
6. The Principal and/or Athletic Directors of the four final schools may contact the District Tournament Director for comment prior to establishing the actual play-off site. Any objections or comments concerning the final site can be emailed to the volleyball chairperson at sshirl@sasd.us within two hours of the location notification. The volleyball chair will relay comments to the District Chairperson who will make the final decision.
7. All guidelines for determination of the “home” team, order of assigned warm-up, and “official scorebook” will follow regular season practice.
8. All games will follow the PIAA & NFHS guidelines
9. Contact District V Personnel following the game with results:
Jeff Batzel 814-766-4752 & Scott Shirley 814-691-7184 District 5 Tournament Director.

The following announcement must be made at all Volleyball Playoffs: THE OFFICIAL VOLLEYBALL OF DISTRICT 5 IS THE BADEN PERFECTION VX5EC-210 (Red, White, and Blue).

DISTRICT 9 VOLLEYBALL TOURNAMENT: CLASS 3A

Details available on PIAA District 9 website.

District V (2) – Bedford High School & Chestnut Ridge High School

District VIII (2) – Carrick High School & Perry High School

District IX (3)– Brockway Area High School & Karns City High School & St. Marys Area High School

A maximum of 6 teams will qualify for the AAA subregion based on a qualifying power ranking system.

- Qualifying & Seeding will be done using a ranking system that includes Victory Points + Power Points divided by the total # of regular season matches played.
- Only regular season matches will count in the ranking system. Conference championship matches, District playoff matches, and matches played in weekend or weekday multi-team volleyball tournaments will NOT count in the ranking system.
- Victory points include – 5 points for a victory in a regular season match and 0 points for a loss
- Schedule points include the following (you receive schedule points for a win or a loss)
 - 3.0 points for playing a 6A school
 - 2.5 points for playing a 5A school
 - 2.0 points for playing a 4A; school
 - 1.5 points for playing a 3A school
 - 2.0 points for playing a 2A school
 - 0.5 points for playing a 1A school
- Formula – Add victory points + schedule points and divide by the total number of matches played
- Schools will submit their power ranking form to their respective District Volleyball chairperson and the respective District Volleyball chairperson will then forward the teams information to Aaron Straub on the following dates – **September 25; October 9; and October 23rd**
- The last day to count matches; submit forms; and enter the tournament is Friday, October 23rd

Tournament format:

- Quarter-final and Semi-final matches will be played at the higher seeded school with the host school, in conjunction of the host district, absorbing all costs associated with the match. The host district will make all match arrangements including the hiring of officials.
- The Quarter final matches (#3 seed hosting the #6 seed) and the (#4 seed hosting the #5 seed) will be played on Tuesday, November 3rd. The #1 and #2 teams will receive a bye in the Quarter Final round.
- The Semifinal matches (#1 seed hosting the winner of the #4/#5 match) and the #2 seed hosting the winner of the #3/#6 match) will be played on Thursday, November 5th.
- The Sub-regional Final match will be played on Saturday, November 7th and will be held at a neutral site within the district of the higher seeded school of two competing schools. In the event that two schools playing in Sub-regional finals are from the same district, the volleyball tournament director from that district reserves the right to play the match at the higher seeded home school if a neutral site cannot be secured.
- In the event that less than 6 teams enter the Sub-regional tournament the format will be adjusted to align with the number of teams that are entered.
- District IX will order and cover the cost for 25 First Place and 25 Second Place medals. No team plaque will be awarded. By virtue of having the most schools, District IX is recognized as the host District for the AAA Sub-regional tournament.
- Admission price will be \$8.00 for adults and \$4.00 for students. Hometown Ticketing and a cash option will be available. Officials pay will be determined by the hosting District. Four officials will be used for each contest.
- The Sub-regional champion from District 5/8/9 will host the third-place team from District 7 in the first round of the State Tournament on November 10th or the 11th (as per the State brackets)

DISTRICT 6 VOLLEYBALL TOURNAMENT: CLASS 4A

District 5 (1) – Somerset Area High School

District 6 (2) – Bellefonte High School & Central Mountain High School

District 8 (2)– Brashear High School & Obama Academy High School

1 – State Qualifier (@ District 4-1 seed)

Details available on PIAA District 6 website.

District 5 (Somerset) will play the winner of the two District 8 teams (Brashear versus Obama Academy) with District 8 hosting this year. The winner will advance to the Sub-regional Finals. District 6 teams (Bellefonte and Central Mountain) will play each other and the winner will advance to the sub-regional finals. The sub-regional finals will be at Altoona High School on November 7th.

DISTRICT 5 VOLLEYBALL PLAYOFF TOURNAMENT PAY OUT AMOUNTS ARE TO SUBJECT TO CHANGE

(See District V Handbook)

Please mail or email copies of the financial report to District 5 Treasurer, Scott Close

Scott Close
645 S. Columbia Ave.
Somerset, PA 15501
814-233-5550
sclose@sasd.us

E-mail only to:
jbatzel@nbcsd.org